

ZONE

1. Passage anchor

> “Because of her, I became more willing to step outside my comfort **zone**...”

Passage meaning

zone = an area or range with particular characteristics or limits

區域；範圍

In **comfort zone**, the meaning is figurative:

comfort zone = a familiar psychological range in which a person feels safe, confident, and comfortable

舒適圈；自己熟悉而有安全感的範圍

So:

step outside your comfort zone

= do something unfamiliar, challenging, or uncomfortable in order to grow

走出舒適圈；跨出熟悉、安全的範圍

Practice

1. Giving presentations helped me move beyond my **comfort zone**.

做簡報幫助我走出自己的**舒適圈**。

2. Growth often begins when we leave our **comfort zone**.

成長往往從離開**舒適圈**開始。

Core meanings of ZONE

2. zone — an area with particular features or boundaries

= an area that is distinguished from surrounding areas because it has a particular purpose, condition, or characteristic

區域；地帶

This is the central noun meaning.

Examples

1. This is a pedestrian **zone**.

這裡是**行人專用區**。

2. The city has several industrial **zones**.

這座城市有幾個工業**區**。

Common:

* residential zone 住宅區

* industrial zone 工業區

* commercial zone 商業區

* restricted zone 管制區

* safety zone 安全區

3. zone — area defined by rules or use

= a place officially designated for a certain purpose or governed by certain rules

專用區；管制區

Examples

1. Parking is not allowed in this **zone**.

這個**區域**禁止停車。

2. The airport has a secure **zone** for staff only.

機場設有僅限員工進入的安全**管制區**。

Geographic and environmental use

4. climate zone

= a large geographical area with a particular type of climate

氣候帶；氣候區

Examples

1. The country lies in a tropical climate **zone**.

這個國家位於熱帶氣候**帶**。

2. Different plants thrive in different climate **zones**.

不同植物適合生長在不同的氣候**區**。

5. time zone

= one of the world's regions that shares the same standard time

****時區****

Examples

1. Seattle and Tokyo are in different ****time zones****.
西雅圖和東京位於不同的****時區****。
2. Travelling across several ****time zones**** can be tiring.
跨越多個****時區****旅行可能很累。

Very common fixed compound.

6. geographical / ecological zone

= an area characterized by particular physical or ecological conditions

****地理區；生態區帶****

Examples

1. The mountain contains several ecological ****zones****.
這座山包含數個生態****區帶****。
2. Different species live in different vegetation ****zones****.
不同物種生活在不同植被****區域****。

Danger, safety, and control

7. danger zone

= an area or situation involving significant danger

****危險區；危險地帶****

Examples

1. People were told to leave the ****danger zone****.
人們被要求離開****危險區域****。
2. The climbers had entered a high-risk ****danger zone****.

登山者已進入高風險的**危險地帶**。

Can be literal or figurative.

8. safety zone / safe zone

= an area intended to protect people from danger

安全區；安全地帶

Examples

1. Residents were moved to a **safe zone**.

居民被轉移到**安全區**。

2. Wait inside the marked **safety zone**.

請在標示的**安全區域**內等待。

9. restricted zone

= an area where access is limited or prohibited

限制區；禁區；管制區

Examples

1. Visitors are not allowed inside the **restricted zone**.

訪客不得進入**管制區**。

2. The building contains several **restricted zones**.

這棟建築內有幾個**限制進入區域**。

Range / band rather than physical place

10. zone — a range within which something operates or exists

= a band or range of values, conditions, or performance

範圍；區間

Examples

1. Keep your heart rate within the target **zone**.

把心率維持在目標**區間**內。

2. The temperature is now in the optimal **zone**.
溫度現在位於最佳**範圍**。

This is an important abstract extension.

11. target zone

= desired range of values or performance

目標區間

Examples

1. Your heart rate should remain in the target **zone**.
你的心率應保持在目標**區間**內。
2. The system is operating within its target **zone**.
系統正在目標**範圍**內運作。

Psychological / figurative range

12. comfort zone

= a situation or psychological range in which someone feels familiar, safe, and confident
****舒適圈****

This is the exact passage use.

Examples

1. Public speaking was far outside my **comfort zone**.
公開演講遠遠超出了我的**舒適圈**。
2. Trying something new can push you beyond your **comfort zone**.
嘗試新事物可以推動你走出**舒適圈**。

13. outside your comfort zone

= beyond what feels familiar or easy

****超出舒適圈；超出熟悉範圍****

Examples

1. The new role took me outside my ****comfort zone****.
這個新職位讓我走出了自己的****舒適圈****。
2. Learning to lead a team was initially outside her ****comfort zone****.
一開始，帶領團隊超出了她熟悉的****舒適範圍****。

14. in the zone

= in a state of intense concentration and highly effective performance

****進入最佳狀態；完全投入****

Examples

1. Once she starts writing, she gets ****in the zone****.
她一開始寫作，就會進入****高度專注的狀態****。
2. The athlete said he felt completely ****in the zone****.
那名運動員表示自己完全進入了****最佳狀態****。

This is informal and very common.

15. zone out

= stop paying attention and become mentally disconnected from what is happening

****走神；發呆；放空****

Examples

1. I ****zoned out**** halfway through the lecture.
我上課上到一半就****走神了****。
2. She tends to ****zone out**** when she is tired.
她累的時候往往會****放空****。

This is a highly useful phrasal verb.

Sports

16. zone — designated area in a sport

= a particular area of a playing field, court, or game space

****區域；防守區****

Examples

1. The player moved into the scoring ****zone****.
那名球員進入了得分****區域****。
2. Defenders were assigned different ****zones****.
防守球員被分配到不同的防守****區域****。

17. zone defense

= a defensive strategy in which players guard areas rather than specific opponents

****區域防守****

Examples

1. The team switched to a ****zone defense****.
球隊改採****區域防守****。
2. They struggled against the opponent's ****zone defense****.
他們很難應付對手的****區域防守****。

Especially common in basketball.

Urban planning and property

18. zoning

= regulation of how land may be used in different areas

****土地使用分區；都市分區管制****

Examples

1. Local ****zoning**** rules limit building height.
當地的****土地使用分區規定****限制建築高度。

2. The project requires a change in **zoning**.

這個專案需要變更**都市分區規劃**。

19. zone — verb: designate an area for a particular use

= officially assign land to a category of use

劃分為.....區；劃定用途

Examples

1. The land is **zoned for residential use**.

這塊土地被**劃為住宅用地**。

2. The area was **zoned as commercial property**.

該地區被**劃定為商業用地**。

20. zoned

= officially designated for a particular use

劃定用途的；分區的

Examples

1. The property is **zoned residential**.

該土地被**劃為住宅用途**。

2. This district is **zoned for mixed use**.

這個地區被**劃為混合用途區**。

Transport and fares

21. fare zone / travel zone

= an area used to determine transport fares or travel rules

票價區；交通分區

Examples

1. The airport is in a different fare **zone**.

機場位於另一個票價**區**。

2. Your ticket is valid in three travel **zones**.

你的票可在三個交通**區域**內使用。

Computing / systems

22. zone — defined logical or administrative area

In technical contexts, **zone** can mean a defined part of a system or network.

區域；區段；邏輯區

Examples

1. The network is divided into security **zones**.

網路被分成不同安全**區域**。

2. Each **zone** has different access rules.

每個**區域**都有不同的存取規則。

Technical, but established.

Anatomy / medicine / science

23. zone — a band or region distinguished from surrounding tissue or material

= a particular layer, band, or region with identifiable characteristics

帶；區；層

Examples

1. The image shows a damaged **zone** around the tissue.

影像顯示組織周圍有一個受損**區域**。

2. Scientists examined the transition **zone**.

科學家檢查了過渡**區**。

Lower-priority general vocabulary, but common across technical domains.

High-value fixed expressions

24. no-go zone

= an area that people should not or cannot enter; figuratively, a topic or area to avoid

****禁區；不可進入的區域；不宜觸碰的話題****

Examples

1. The damaged building was declared a ****no-go zone****.

那棟受損建築被宣布為****禁區****。

2. Money was a ****no-go zone**** in their conversations.

錢在他們的談話中是個****不能碰的話題****。

25. buffer zone

= an area separating two other areas to reduce conflict, danger, or interference

****緩衝區****

Examples

1. A ****buffer zone**** separates the two areas.

兩個區域之間有一個****緩衝區****。

2. Trees were planted as a ****buffer zone**** between the road and the houses.

道路與住宅之間種了樹作為****緩衝帶****。

26. exclusion zone

= an area from which people are officially excluded

****禁入區；封鎖區****

Examples

1. Police created an ****exclusion zone**** around the building.

警方在建築物周圍設立了****封鎖區****。

2. Residents were kept outside the ****exclusion zone****.

居民不得進入****禁入區****。

27. war zone

= an area where armed conflict is taking place

****戰區****

Examples

1. Journalists entered the ****war zone****.

記者進入了****戰區****。

2. Thousands of people fled the ****war zone****.

數千人逃離****戰區****。

Related forms

28. zoning

As above, ****zoning**** can mean:

A. official land-use regulation

****土地使用分區****

B. dividing something into zones

****分區；區域劃分****

Example

The building uses ****zoning**** to control heating separately on each floor.

這棟建築採用****分區控制****，讓每層樓的暖氣可以分開調節。

29. zonal

= relating to a zone or zones

****區域的；分區的****

Examples

1. The system uses ****zonal heating****.

這套系統使用****分區供暖****。

2. Researchers compared ****zonal differences**** in climate.

研究人員比較了不同**區域差異**。

More technical and lower frequency.

Key contrasts

30. zone vs area

area

= very broad general word for a part of a place, subject, or field

地區；區域；範圍

zone

= an area distinguished by a particular function, characteristic, rule, or boundary

特定區域；地帶

Compare:

> a shopping **area**

> 購物區域

> a pedestrian **zone**

> 行人專用區

zone usually implies clearer classification.

31. zone vs region

region

= a relatively large geographical area

地區；區域

zone

= an area defined by a characteristic, use, or boundary

地帶；區帶

Compare:

> the northern **region**

> 北部地區

> the tropical climate **zone**

> 熱帶氣候帶

32. zone vs district

****district****

= an officially or commonly recognized part of a town, city, or administrative area

****區 ; 行政區****

****zone****

= an area defined by function, restriction, or condition

****區域 ; 地帶****

Compare:

* business district 商業區

* restricted zone 管制區

33. zone vs range

In abstract uses:

****zone****

= a defined band within a range

****區間****

****range****

= the full span between limits

****範圍****

Compare:

> Keep your heart rate in the target ****zone****.

> 把心率維持在目標區間。

> The normal heart-rate ****range**** is...

> 正常心率範圍是.....

34. comfort zone vs safe zone

****comfort zone****

= psychological range where you feel familiar and comfortable

****舒適圈****

****safe zone****

= a place or condition intended to protect from danger

****安全區****

They should not be treated as synonyms.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****zone**** is:

****an area separated or distinguished from surrounding areas****

From this develop several branches:

Physical place

industrial zone

→ ****區域；地帶****

Official classification

restricted zone / residential zone

→ ****管制區；分區****

Geographic band

climate zone / time zone

→ ****氣候帶；時區****

Numerical range

target zone

→ ****目標區間****

Psychological boundary

comfort zone

→ ****舒適圈****

Mental state

in the zone / zone out

→ **進入最佳狀態 / 走神**

Technical division

security zone

→ **系統區域**

The passage use relies on a spatial metaphor:

physical zone with boundaries

→ **psychological range with familiar boundaries**

Passage recap

> “...I became more willing to step outside my comfort **zone** ...”

Here:

zone is part of **comfort zone**.

It means:

the familiar psychological range in which you feel safe, confident, and comfortable

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **舒適圈**

* **熟悉而有安全感的範圍**

* **自己習慣的心理範圍**

MCQ-ready meaning

zone in **“comfort zone”

= **a defined range or area, used figuratively for the limits within which someone feels comfortable**

範圍；區域 → 舒適圈

The meaning is not a literal geographical zone here, but the metaphor still depends on the idea of
a bounded area that you can stay inside or step outside.